Case Interview Frameworks Cheat Sheet

Scan the QR for information about our top-rated case prep program – *Black Belt*. In Black Belt, an expert coach will guide you through the prep process via 8 1hr, 1:1 virtual coaching sessions. Need frameworks help? Work with your coach on live drills and get game-changing feedback on the fly.

Mix and match these frameworks to solve your next case!

Grow Revenue

- The Profitability Framework (just Price & Volume)
- The 3 C's + Business Situation Framework
- The 4 P's Framework
- Porter's Five Forces
- The Pricing Framework (scenario dependent)
- New Market Framework (scenario dependent)
- New Product Framework (scenario dependent)

Cut Costs / Improve Operations

- The Profitability Framework (just Fixed & Variable Costs)
- The 3 C's + Business Situation Framework

Improve Profitability

- The Profitability Framework
- The 3 C's + Business Situation Framework
- The 4 P's Framework
- Porter's Five Forces

M&A and Divestures

- M&A (Mergers & Acquisitions) Framework



Here are samples of the eight “starter” frameworks you need to know!

Sample Profitability Framework

Price

- What is our client pricing products at?
- How has pricing changed over the past few years?
- What is our pricing strategy?
- How is pricing expected to change over the next few years?
- What are competitors pricing similar products at?

Quantity

- What is the demand for our client's products?
- How has demand been changing over the past few years?
- How is the client marketing its products? How have our marketing efforts affected demand?

Variable Costs

- What are the variable costs with regards to variable labor? Has this been changing?
- What are the variable costs with regards to materials? Has this been changing?
- What are the variable costs with regards to distribution? Has this been changing?

Fixed Costs

- What are the fixed costs with regards to salaried labor? Has this been changing?
- What are the fixed costs with regards to rents? Has this been changing?
- What are the fixed costs with regards to utilities? Has this been changing?



Sample Pricing Framework

Product Information

- What is product and how is it different from what is in market?
- How innovative is this product compared to others?
- Is the product patented or have similar rights?
- Are there similar products in market that can act as substitutes?
- Can the product be bundled with existing products?
- Could product cannibalize any of our current products?
- What were R&D costs?
- How big is market for product?

Competitive Analysis

- How much are competitors charging for similar products?
- How are competitors thinking about their pricing strategies?
- How much does it cost for competitors to create similar products?
- What are substitutions to our client's product?

Pricing Strategy

- What is our breakeven point?
- How much does it cost to create and deliver the product?
- Has there been any research completed to see how much customers are willing to pay for the product or similar ones?
- Do customers need to be educated about the product?
- What are the potential costs with bringing this product to market?
- How much will be spent on marketing?

Sample 3C's and Business Situation Framework

Company

- What defines the company?
- What are the company's core competencies?
- How long has the company been around?
- What does the company's financial performance look like over the past few years?
- What is the company's management team like?
- How strong is our company's brand?
- What are our client's competitive advantages? What are our client's weaknesses?

Customer

- Who is the customer?
- What are the customer demographics?
- How are customers segmented? What kind of growth have each of these segments seen over the past few years? How are they projected to grow?
- How sensitive are customers to prices?
- What are the distribution channels through which the client reaches its customers?

Competition

- Who are the competitors in the market and what is their market share?
- How quickly is each competitor growing?
- Do our competitors offer products or services that our client does not?
- How is the competition marketing their products?
- How is the competition pricing their products?

Product

- What is product and how is it different from what is in market?
- How innovative is this product compared to others?
- Is the product patented or have similar rights?
- Are there similar products in market that can act as substitutes?
- Can the product be bundled with existing products?
- Could product cannibalize any of our current products?
- What were R&D costs?
- How big is market?



Sample 4 P's Framework

Product

- What is the product and how is it different from what is on the market?
- How innovative is this product compared to others in the market?
- Is the product patented or have any rights that can protect it from being copied?
- Are there similar products in the market that can act as substitutes?
- Will the product cannibalize any of the client's current products?

Price

- What is our current pricing strategy?
- What is our breakeven point?
- Has there been any research completed to see how much customers are willing to pay for the product or similar ones?
- Do customers need to be educated about the product?

Promotion

- What marketing strategies have been implemented so far? Which have been successful, and which have
- not?
- What are the ways competitors have been marketing their products?
- How much is spent on marketing?

Place

- Which distribution channels are used to distribute the products?
- Which channels best reach our customers?
- Is a salesforce needed to reach our customers?
- What channels have been most successful for our client in the past? How about competitors?

Sample Porter's Five Forces Framework

Threat of New Entrants

- What are the barriers to entry in this industry?
- How do economies of scale work in this industry?
- What are some cost advantages our client has?
- What kind of access does our client have to distribution channels?
- How is our client's product protected from new entrants?

Competitive Dynamics

- Who are the other
- competitors in the market and what are their market shares?
- How quickly are the other competitors growing?
- What are our client's competitive advantages? What are our client's weaknesses?
- Do competitors compete on price in this market?

Supplier Power

- Howmany suppliers are there in the market?
- Who are the key suppliers?
- How much bargaining power do suppliers have in the market? Is there a lot of differentiation amongst suppliers?

Buyer Power

- Who are the key customers? What is the cost for buyers to switch to different competing companies?
- How much bargaining power do customers have?
- Do customers have equal information to the products on the market?

Threat of Substitutes

- Are there any notable substitutes in the market for our client's products that have similar prices and qualities?
- What is the cost for switching to other similar products for the customer?

Sample Market Entry Framework

Market Situation

- What is market size?
- What is projected market growth/ decline over next 1, 3, 5, or 10 yrs?
- At what rate has market been growing/ declining over the past 1, 3, 5, or 10 yrs?
- Where is the market in its life cycle?
- Who are customers and how are they segmented?
- Will client's products become less useful over time with tech advances?
- Have there been major changes in the market lately?
- What are key factors that drive the industry?

Competition

- Who are the main competitors and what are their market shares?
- How do the competitors' products compare to our client's?
- How will the competition respond?
- What are our client's competitive advantages?

Market Entry Considerations

- What are the key risks to consider?
- Are there any barriers to entry?
- Would it be more profitable to enter through an acquisition, a joint venture, or by creating a business from scratch?
- How will the client exit the new market if things don't go well?



Sample New Product Framework

New Product and Product Portfolio

- What is the new product and how is it different from what is currently on the market?
- How innovative is this product compared to others in the market?
- Is the product patented or have any rights that can protect it from being copied?
- Are there similar products in the market that can act as substitutes?
- How does the product fit within the client's current product line?
- Can the product be bundled with any existing products?
- Will the product cannibalize any of the client's current products?
- Is the client replacing an existing product?

Market Strategy

- Who are our customers and how can we best reach them
- How will this product expand our customer base and increase sales?
- Is there any data or research supporting that customers want this product?
- Who are the main competitors and how much market share does each firm have?
- How will competitors respond to this new product?
- Are we entering a new market or are we serving the market we currently serve?

Feasibility

- How much funding does this new product require?
- Where will the funding come from?
- If debt is required, can the client support debt?
- Does the client have the manufacturing or production capabilities to produce this product on its own or does it need help from other parties?
- Do we have relationships with the right suppliers that will help us create this product?
- How will this new product impact our client's profitability?

Sample M&A Framework

Target Market

- If our client doesn't purchase the company, will a competitor?
- How healthy is the industry the target is in?
- How will competitors respond to this acquisition?

Target Company

- How are the potential acquisition target's financials?
- Has the target's revenue and profitability been increasing or decreasing over the past few years?
- How unique are the target's products?
- What is the target's customer base like?

Post-Acquisition Strategy

- How much is client going to be paying? What are deal terms?
- Is the price fair?
- How will the deal be financed?
- Will our client be taking on debt, and if so, can the client support it?
- Why is client thinking about purchasing the asset or company?
- Are there potential alternatives?
- How does company fit within client's broader product portfolio and strategy?
- Are there potential revenue / cost synergies?

Risks and Benefits

- Has the target's revenue and profitability been increasing or decreasing over the past few years?
- How special are target's products?
- What is target's customer base like?
- How healthy is industry the target is in?
- How will competitors respond?
- Are there legal or regulatory reasons this acquisition may not work?
- Are there financial reasons (i.e., tax advantages) that make this worthwhile?



Join Black Belt for a personalized case prep plan designed by an MBB coach.

Scan the QR for more info and a link to buy today.